English Grammar Reference

Simple Present Tense — Rules, Structures & Examples

1. WHEN TO USE THE SIMPLE PRESENT TENSE

Habits & Routines

Actions that happen regularly or repeatedly.
Example: I drink coffee every morning.

General Facts

Universal truths and permanent states.
Example: The sun rises in the east.

Fixed Schedules

Timetables and scheduled future events.
Example: The bus leaves at 8:00 AM.

2. SENTENCE STRUCTURES

A. Positive Sentences (+)

Subject	Verb Rule	Example
I / You / We / They	Base verb	They **play** soccer on Sundays.
He / She / It	Base verb + **-s / -es**	She **plays** soccer on Sundays.

Important Rule for Third Person (He / She / It): Always add **-s** or **-es** to the verb in positive sentences!

B. Negative Sentences (-)

Subject	Auxiliary + Not	Example (Base Verb)
I / You / We / They	**do not** (don't)	I **don't like** tea.
He / She / It	**does not** (doesn't)	He **doesn't like** tea. *(No -s on like!)*

2. SENTENCE STRUCTURES (CONTINUED)

C. Questions (?)

Auxiliary	Subject	Base Verb & Example
Do	I / you / we / they	**Do** you **work** here?
Does	he / she / it	**Does** she **work** here?

3. SPELLING RULES FOR HE / SHE / IT

- **Most verbs:** Add `-s` → *work* → *works* | *eat* → *eats*
- **Verbs ending in -ch, -sh, -s, -x, -z, -o:** Add `-es` → *watch* → *watches* | *go* → *goes*
- **Verbs ending in Consonant + Y:** Change Y to `-ies` → *study* → *studies* | *fly* → *flies*
- **Verbs ending in Vowel + Y:** Add `-s` → *play* → *plays* | *enjoy* → *enjoys*

4. SPECIAL CASE: THE VERB "TO BE" (AM / IS / ARE)

The verb **to be** does not use *do/does* for negatives or questions.

- **Positive:** I **am** ready. / She **is** happy. / They **are** teachers.
- **Negative:** I **am not** ready. / She **is not** happy. / They **are not** teachers.
- **Question: Is** she happy? / **Are** they teachers?

5. COMMON SIGNAL WORDS

These frequency adverbs often signal the use of the Simple Present Tense:

- **Adverbs:** Always, Usually, Often, Sometimes, Seldom, Never
- **Time expressions:** Every day, Every week, On Mondays, Once a month